SLEEP 07

# Hexarelin

Synthetic six-amino-acid growth hormone-releasing peptide (GHRP), related to GHRP-6



| CLASS | STUDIED FOR | HUMAN EVIDENCE | US STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Peptide (GHRP) | GH release, heart pumping | Small human studies | Not FDA approved |

## STUDIED FOR

- **Growth hormone** — HUMAN
- **Heart pumping** — HUMAN + ANIMAL
- **Sleep** — HUMAN
- **Growth in children** — HUMAN

**The one sleep study was small.** In 7 healthy volunteers, deep sleep and EEG delta power fell after hexarelin. No registered trial was found.

## EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

### EVIDENCE

**SMALL HUMAN**
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- Small studies, mostly single doses
- Largest: 24 men in bypass surgery
- No registered trial found

### NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Long-term heart effects
- Drug interactions

## HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Hexarelin → GHS receptor → GH, cortisol, PRL → Hormones, heart

- **Strong GH release** in people after vein, skin, nasal or oral dosing
- **Also raises** cortisol, ACTH and prolactin, not only growth hormone
- **Heart studies** suggest direct action on heart-muscle GHS receptors
- **GH response weakened** over 16 weeks of use and recovered after stopping

## QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

| HALF-LIFE | ROUTES STUDIED |
|---|---|
| Not established in people | Into a vein, under the skin, nasal spray, by mouth (studies) |
| **PHARMACOKINETICS** | **SOLD AS** |
| Limited human data | "Research use only" (not legal for human use) |
| **MONITORED IN TRIALS** | **SPORT (WADA)** |
| GH, IGF-1, cortisol, prolactin, ejection fraction | Prohibited, class S2 |

**REGULATORY**

| | |
|---|---|
| FDA | Not approved |
| FDA | Not on the 503A or 503B bulk lists |
| WADA | Prohibited (S2.2.4, as examorelin) |


REFERENCES

1. Frieboes et al., Psychoneuroendocrinology, hexarelin and sleep, Aug 2004
2. Rahim et al., J Clin Endocrinol Metab, 16 weeks of hexarelin, May 1998
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List



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